

Real Fraud-Safety Tips

- 1. Never share OTPs, PINs, passwords, or card details with anyone** – RBI and banks never ask for these over phone, SMS, or email.
- 2. RBI never sends account suspension notices via WhatsApp or asks customers to share financial information through the platform.**
- 3. Never download unknown APK files or click on suspicious links** received through unsolicited messages.
- 4. “Unknown Link” = “Unknown Risk.”** Banks and NBFCs do not send links for KYC updates. If a message asks you to click a link to prevent account blocking, treat it as a red flag.
- 5. Stop, Think, and Act** – Don’t rush into clicking links or following instructions from unexpected messages or calls. Verify independently.
- 6. Do not share KYC documents or copies with unknown individuals or organizations.**
- 7. RBI does not make individual calls or send voicemails threatening account suspension.**
- 8. For unclaimed deposits, access ONLY the official UDGM portal: udgm.rbi.org.in.** Do not click suspicious links claiming to help withdraw unclaimed funds.
- 9. Beware of fraudulent campaigns promising loan waivers** – these are fake and may involve requests for advance payments or legal fees. Approach your lending institution directly.
- 10. RBI communicates on WhatsApp ONLY through its two verified blue-tick numbers: 99309 91935 and 99990 41935.**
- 11. Do not click on unknown links** – delete SMS/emails with unknown links immediately.
- 12. Do not share sensitive data through unverified/unauthorized websites or applications.**
- 13. Ignore unsolicited emails, calls, and messages promising large sums of money, lottery winnings, or donation programs.**
- 14. In case of financial cyber fraud, immediately call the National Cyber Crime Helpline at 1930 or file a complaint at cybercrime.gov.in.**
- 15. Report suspicious government-related messages to PIB Fact Check** – WhatsApp: +91 8799711259, Email: factcheck@pib.gov.in.

Fake Scam Messages

Category A: RBI Impersonation & Account Suspension

1. "RBI ALERT: Your bank account has been linked to suspicious transactions. To avoid account suspension, download the attached APK file and submit your banking details within 3 working days. – Reserve Bank of India"
2. "ATTENTION: RBI has detected unusual activity in your account. Click here to verify your identity immediately: <http://rbi-update.xyz/verify>. Failure to comply will result in permanent account blockage."
3. "RESERVE BANK OF INDIA: Your account is under risk control measures. Download the RBI security app from the link below to prevent restrictions. <http://rbi-secure.apk-download.com>"
4. "RBI Notice: Your credit card has been involved in fraudulent activity. Your bank account will be blocked within 24 hours. Press 1 to speak to an RBI officer immediately."
5. "RBI Kehta Hai: Your PAN card is not linked to your bank account. Your account will be frozen today. Update KYC now: <http://rbikyc-update.in>"

Category B: KYC Update Scams

6. "Your bank account will be BLOCKED today if KYC is not updated. Click here to complete KYC: <http://kyc-update-bank.in>. Do not ignore this message."
7. "IMPORTANT: Your KYC details are incomplete. Your account will be deactivated in 12 hours. Update now through this secure link: <http://bank-kyc-verify.co>"
8. "SBI YONO Alert: Your Aadhaar is not updated with YONO app. Your account will be blocked permanently. Update Aadhaar here: <http://sbi-aadhaar-update.com>"
9. "KYC COMPULSORY: RBI mandates all bank customers to update KYC by midnight. Failure = account blocked. Link: <http://rbi-kyc-portal.in>"
10. "Your SBI account will be deactivated because Aadhaar is not linked. Click to link Aadhaar immediately: <http://sbi-aadhaar-link.in>"

Category C: Loan Waiver & Financial Scams

11. "Congratulations! Your outstanding loan of ₹5,00,000 has been approved for waiver under RBI's special scheme. Pay ₹5,000 processing fee to claim your waiver certificate: <http://rbi-loanwaiver.in>"
12. "RBI Loan Waiver Program 2026: All bank loans up to ₹10 lakh are eligible for complete waiver. Register now with a ₹2,500 fee. Limited slots! Contact: 98765XXXXX"

13. "Your education loan has been selected for RBI's Debt Relief Campaign. Pay ₹3,500 legal fees and receive your debt waiver certificate today!"

Category D: UDGAM/Unclaimed Deposits Scams

14. "RBI UDGAM Portal: You have ₹2,85,000 lying unclaimed in an old bank account. Click here to withdraw now: <http://udgam-claim.in>"

15. "Unclaimed Deposit Alert: ₹4,50,000 from your dormant account is waiting. Visit the RBI UDGAM portal through this link to claim: <http://rbi-udgam-claim.com>"

Category E: Reward Points & Offers

16. "SBI Rewards: You have accumulated ₹9,800 worth of reward points. Redeem now before they expire: <http://sbi-rewards-redeem.in/download-app>"

17. "Congratulations! You've won ₹10,00,000 in the RBI Donation Program 2026. Pay ₹1,500 credit fee to receive your winnings. <http://rbi-donation-2026.com>"

18. "Your credit card has earned 50,000 bonus points. Claim your reward now: <http://bank-rewards-claim.in>. Offer valid for 24 hours only!"

Category F: Voice Call & Impersonation Scams

19. "RBI Automated Voicemail: Your bank account will be blocked due to credit card fraud. Press 1 to connect with an RBI officer immediately."

20. "This is the Reserve Bank of India. Your account has been flagged for money laundering. Share your OTP to verify your identity. Do not share this with anyone else."

Category G: Miscellaneous

21. "Your parcel could not be delivered due to incorrect address. Pay ₹150 redelivery fee: <http://indiapost-redelivery.in>"

22. "ICICI Bank: Your LPG connection will be disconnected within 24 hours due to incomplete KYC. Update here: <http://lpg-kyc-update.in>"

23. "Traffic Challan Alert: You have an outstanding challan of ₹2,000. Pay immediately to avoid legal action: <http://traffic-challan-pay.in>"

24. "SBI Alert: Your YONO app has been deactivated. Re-activate by downloading the latest version: <http://sbi-yono-update.apk>"

25. "RBI Security Update: 2FA mandatory for all accounts. Verify your mobile number here: <http://rbi-2fa-verify.in>"

Safe Messages

1. "RBI Kehta Hai: Never share your OTP, PIN, password or card details with anyone. Banks never ask for these. Stay safe!"

2. “Dear Customer, your KYC is due for periodic update. Please visit your nearest branch or log in to the official bank app to complete the process. Never click on unknown links.”
3. “RBI Alert: Banks never send links for KYC updates. If you receive such a message, do not click. Contact your bank directly through official channels.”
4. “Security Tip: Unknown Link = Unknown Risk. Delete suspicious SMS/emails with unknown links immediately. Verify any website before sharing financial details.”
5. “RBI reminds: For unclaimed deposits, visit only the official UDGM portal at udgam.rbi.org.in. RBI never asks for OTPs or passwords.”
6. “Stay Alert! Do not share login details, personal information, KYC documents, card information, PIN, password, or OTP with unknown people or through unverified websites.”
7. “RBI Official WhatsApp numbers: 99309 91935 and 99990 41935. Any other message claiming to be from RBI on WhatsApp is fake. Do not engage.”
8. “In case of cyber fraud, immediately call 1930 or file a complaint at cybercrime.gov.in. Early reporting increases chances of fund recovery.”
9. “RBI warns: Fake loan waiver offers are scams. Approach your lending institution directly for any loan-related information. Do not pay fees to third parties.”
10. “Beware of calls claiming your account will be blocked. RBI does not make such calls. If you receive one, hang up and report it. Never share personal information.”

Risk-Tag List (Plain Words)

Risk Tag	What It Means
Urgency	Message creates panic or a false sense of emergency (e.g., “act now,” “within 24 hours,” “immediately,” “your account will be blocked”) to pressure you into quick decisions without thinking
Fake Link	Message contains a suspicious URL that does NOT match the official website of the bank/RBI/govt (e.g., misspelled domains like “rbi- update.xyz ” instead of “ rbi.org.in ”)
Account Threat	Message threatens to block, suspend, freeze, or deactivate your bank account unless you take immediate action
OTP Request	Message asks you to share OTP, PIN, password, card number, CVV, Aadhaar, or any other sensitive personal/financial information
APK/Download	Message asks you to download an APK file or install an unknown application
Advance Fee	Message asks you to pay money upfront to receive a larger sum, loan waiver, lottery, or reward
Fake Offer	Message promises unrealistic rewards, loan waivers, lottery winnings, or unclaimed deposits

Impersonation	Message pretends to be from RBI, a bank, the government, or a trusted authority
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